



What Is a Variable?

Day 1 of 20 · Theme: Minnesota State Fair

MINNESOTA STANDARDS (MDE 2022)

Standard: 9.3.5.3

Standard: 9.3.5.7

Standard: 9.3.5.8

LEARNING OBJECTIVES & SUCCESS CRITERIA

- I can apply the lesson's core skill with fluency and check my answers for reasonableness.
- I can explain my reasoning using math vocabulary.
- I can connect the math to the lesson's real-world career and cultural context.

ENGAGEMENT & PACING

Strategy: Think-Pair-Share **Practice Format:** Merit Time Game — Translation Match **Duration:** 50 minutes

TEACHER ANNOTATIONS — PRACTICE ANSWERS (VERIFIED)

Scaffold (Tier 1) Prompt: A number n is tripled then increased by 4. Write an algebraic expression.

Model answers:

- $3n + 4$ **On-Level (Tier 2) Prompt:** x decreased by 9. The product of 6 and a number y . *Model answers:*
- $x - 9$ and $6y$ **Extension (Tier 3) Prompt:** Twice a number increased by 3 equals 15. Write an equation and find the number. *Model answers:*
- $2n + 3 = 15$, $n = 6$

EXIT TICKET — ANSWER & SCORING

Exit ticket: Show your work for full credit *Scoring: 1 point per exit ticket; mastery = 4 of 4. Collect before the final 5 minutes; address misconceptions next lesson's bell ringer.*

DIFFERENTIATION (3 TIERS)

- Tier 1 (Support): Use tiered practice 'go'; provide a GEMDAS keyword bank and sentence starters.
- Tier 2 (On-Level): Work 'set' problems; partner check before whole-class reveal.
- Tier 3 (Challenge): Complete 'extra' extension; ask students to create their own verbal phrase.

CULTURE & CAREER CONNECTION

- Culture: Ojibwe ☐ (Tribal Nations) Ojibwe families harvest wild rice (manoomin) together from canoes, measuring and counting each harvest's pounds of grain.
- Career: Mayo Clinic — Rochester | Medical Lab Scientist | BS | \$63,150 O*NET SOC: 29-2011.00

MERIT EDUCATION GROUP™ | Intermediate Algebra | Unit 1 | Lesson 1